



November 19th 2018 Delaware County Commissioners Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IAbcSOMg-1Y
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The Delaware County Commissioners meeting was called to order [00:00:06](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Henry, Ms. Reagan, Mr. King, and Mr. Joe Ray (Presiding Officer).
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the November 5th meeting were approved following a motion, second, and roll call vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. King: Yes) [00:00:47](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:01:09](#) Application for EDI Grant Funds / Big-Time Barbell

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Mack Hines (Big-Time Barbell) alongside Brad Bookout (Delaware County Economic Development).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Hines presented an update on his facility's addiction recovery and physical fitness program. He reported that program participation has exceeded expectations, drawing between 17 and 35 attendees twice a week, and the organization has awarded four participant scholarships based on sobriety and meeting attendance. The facility has surpassed 50 members ahead of its five-year financial projection. Commissioners praised the volunteer-run program for its positive community impact.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).
- **00:13:29 CHA Engineering Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookout, presenting alongside Charlie Starling from CHA.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented an updated engineering agreement with CHA for the rail spur access easement. Confirmed with staff that sufficient funds exist in the NTI rail spur account (Project 38) to cover the cost. Although project timelines have been extended due to right-of-way negotiations with Gear Systems USA and Rivieria, staff expressed hope that construction could begin next year.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved in the amount of \$46,365 by Roll Call Vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).
- **00:17:00 BIS Agreement for Juvenile Courts**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented a contract upgrade for juvenile court recording equipment, noting that current systems are approximately 11 years old. Due to budget constraints, funding will prioritize the juvenile court first, with main court upgrades deferred to the next year. Costs will be covered via approved council budget appropriations for next year.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).
- **00:16:53 SRI Commissioners Deed Service Addendum**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County staff and commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed responsibilities and fees associated with taking delinquent properties to deed sale, noting an upfront layout cost of approximately \$275. Commissioners discussed narrowing property lists, eliminating parcels with environmental or civil liabilities, and exploring partnerships with nonprofits for veteran tiny home projects or private buyers willing to pay back taxes and handle demolition.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled to the December 3rd meeting by Roll Call Vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).
- **00:22:12 Ordinance No. 2018-015: Countywide Grant Policy**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Joe (County Attorney/Staff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishes a countywide grant policy adopting the State Board of Accounts model policy to ensure uniform grant approval, record-keeping, and accountability for departments receiving grant funds, addressing prior gaps in communication with the auditor's office.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced, rules suspended, and adopted by successive roll call votes (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:24:42 Ordinance No. 2018-016: Office of Justice Programs Federal Grant Award Acceptance**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Authorizes acceptance of a federal grant award of \$17,400 from the Office of Justice Programs to upgrade current crime reporting systems with new rules.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced, rules suspended, and adopted by successive roll call votes (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:26:22 Ordinance No. 2018-017: Moratorium Amendment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Amendment to Ordinance 2018-004 continuing the moratorium on certain uses within farm zoning in Delaware County, Indiana, through January 22nd.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by Roll Call Vote (Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).
- **00:27:12 Ordinance No. 2018-018: Delaware County Sheriff's Grant Funds**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishes grant funds for a joint grant with the Muncie Police Department (noted as a 2017 delayed federal award).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced, rules suspended, and adopted by successive roll call votes (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:28:28 Ordinance No. 2018-019: Health Department Fee Schedule Amendment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jan Van Pelt, Department Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Amends health department fees to address projected negative fund balances by 2021 driven by circuit breaker property tax impacts. Key changes include increasing birth certificate fees from \$15 to \$20 and death certificate fees from \$10 to \$20 (projecting revenue to rise from \$152,000 to \$255,800). Introduces a seasonal retail food establishment permit to eliminate late fee burdens, a \$1,290 acute care facility inspection permit fee (shifting inspection duties for hospitals like BMH to the local health department under state mandate), and a temporary food establishment fee structure incentivizing advance permit filing.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced for first reading by Roll Call Vote (Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).

- **00:35:00 Payment of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of routine county claims and expenditures.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved in the amount of \$2,321,739.35 by Roll Call Vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Ms. Reagan: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:35:32 Mr. Slater (Resident):** Addressed the board regarding a previous discussion on commercial sewage line hookups for rural properties. He argued that larger landowners paying substantial property taxes (\$50,000+ annually) who maintain approved private septic systems should be exempt from mandatory hookups to newly extended commercial lines. He also questioned staff recommendations on the matter.
- **00:39:47 Mr. Slater (Resident) & Board Members:** During an exchange confirming his upcoming winter travel and retirement from regularly attending monthly meetings, commissioners thanked Mr. Slater and his family for over 30 years of civic engagement and public participation at county meetings.
- **00:41:07 Staff / Board Clarification:** County staff briefly clarified the statutory and practical hurdles regarding septic systems, noting that state law lacks clear guidance on declaring older septic systems “functional,” meaning older systems would generally fail to meet modern standards without extensive reconstruction and state inspection oversight.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Mention of the next meeting scheduled for December 3rd.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially recessed/adjourned following a motion and unanimous aye voice vote **00:42:35**.

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